

# Arizona has no incumbent architect. Raleigh has one, and it just changed hands.

You asked for the Arizona submitted-projects search. It is in here, out of the city's own records. But the list is not the valuable part — the valuable part is what fifty Arizona projects say when you count them properly, and what happens when the same measurement is run on a second market.

Arizona: 12 projects, 11 firms      Raleigh: 11 projects, 7 firms      Top firm: 17% vs 36%

START HERE

## Arizona multifamily has no incumbent architect

Twelve multifamily projects. Eleven different architecture firms. One firm has two of them and nobody has three.

The set is *50 commercial real estate projects to know in 2026*, published by AZ Big Media. It names a design team on 49 of the 50 — developer, architect and general contractor per project. We took every one of those labelled fields and counted them, which turns out to be a different exercise from reading the list.

**Twenty-four per cent of it is multifamily.** Thirty-four per cent is civic and education, twenty per cent industrial, twelve healthcare, ten hospitality. So the first honest thing to say about an “Arizona projects” list is that three-quarters of it is not your market at all. The twelve that are look like this:

| ARCHITECT                    | ARIZONA MULTIFAMILY PROJECTS |
|------------------------------|------------------------------|
| Gensler                      | 2                            |
| triARC architecture & design | 1                            |
| Niles Bolton Associates      | 1                            |
| KTGY                         | 1                            |
| Dig Studio                   | 1                            |
| ESG Architecture & Design    | 1                            |
| LGE Design Build             | 1                            |
| Lamar Johnson Collaborative  | 1                            |
| GFF Design                   | 1                            |
| Athena Studio                | 1                            |
| Soaring Eight                | 1                            |

▲ WHAT THAT ACTUALLY MEANS

In a consolidated market the top firm holds a third or more and the pitch is a displacement argument — you have to take work off somebody. **Here the largest holder of Arizona multifamily work in the set has two projects out of twelve.** There is no incumbent to displace, because there is no incumbent. A firm entering this market is not fighting a share war; it is walking into a field where nobody has established one.

The national multifamily names are present but thin on the ground — **KTGY, Niles Bolton and ESG have one project each.** They are in Arizona. They have not taken it.

## The same measurement in Raleigh gives the opposite answer

A finding that has only been made in one market is a coincidence until it is tested somewhere else. So we ran the identical measurement on Raleigh. **“No incumbent” does not hold there — and that is what makes the Arizona number worth something.**

| MEASURE                             | ARIZONA MULTIFAMILY | RALEIGH MULTIFAMILY       |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------|
| Projects with a confirmed architect | 12                  | 11                        |
| Distinct architecture firms         | <b>11</b>           | <b>7</b>                  |
| Largest single holder               | Gensler, 2 projects | <b>JDAVIS, 4 projects</b> |
| Top firm’s share                    | <b>17%</b>          | <b>36%</b>                |
| Firms per project                   | 0.92                | 0.64                      |

**Raleigh’s leading multifamily architect holds more than double the share Arizona’s does**, out of a field barely half as wide. Cline Design Associates is second with two. Five further firms — Perkins Eastman, Tightlines Design, Studio M, Foley Design and Iwan Architecture & Engineering Consultants — hold one each.

▲ AND THE INCUMBENT CHANGED HANDS FIFTEEN MONTHS AGO

**JDAVIS was acquired by ISG on 14 May 2025.** It is Raleigh-headquartered, 89 staff, and the acquirer is an employee-owned architecture and engineering firm expanding into the region. Every one of the four JDAVIS submittals recovered here was filed in 2024 — designed before that deal closed.

So the two markets ask opposite questions. In Arizona there is no share to take off anyone. **In Raleigh there is a clear leader, and it is fifteen months into an ownership change.**

× CHARLOTTE COULD NOT BE TESTED, AND WE WILL NOT PRETEND OTHERWISE

Three separate routes are closed. Charlotte’s “Committed Development Entitlement” dataset — the richest schema we found anywhere — **stops at 23 May 2022**. Its live rezoning layer carries 86 pending petitions with a petitioner but **no project name and no design team**. And the city’s own rezoning documents return **HTTP 403** to us, so the plan sets that would answer it cannot be read.

The Raleigh method would work on Charlotte the moment those documents are reachable. Today it does not, and a Charlotte number here would be invented.

## Design-build is taking the market — but not your part of it

Design-build is the standard worry about Phoenix, and it is a real one. It is also more precisely located than the worry usually is. Across the 50 projects, the architect and the contractor are **the same firm on six of them — twelve per cent**. Where those six sit is the whole story:

| SECTOR                    | PROJECTS | DESIGN-BUILD | SHARE      |
|---------------------------|----------|--------------|------------|
| Industrial / logistics    | 10       | <b>5</b>     | <b>50%</b> |
| Multifamily / residential | 12       | 1            | 8%         |
| Civic / education         | 17       | 0            | 0%         |
| Healthcare                | 6        | 0            | 0%         |
| Hospitality               | 5        | 0            | 0%         |

**Half of Arizona industrial in this set is design-build. None of the civic, healthcare or hospitality work is, and one multifamily project out of twelve.** Every single design-build project in the set belongs to one firm, LGE Design Build, and five of its six are industrial.

X AND ONE NAME THAT IS NOT WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

**Butler Design Group is not a design-build firm.** It has six projects — joint-most in the set — and six different general contractors: Stevens-Leinweber, Ryan Companies on three, Willmeng and Layton. It is a conventional architecture practice whose name reads like a design-builder.

It is also **not a competitor for multifamily work.** Four of its six are industrial, one healthcare, one civic. **Zero residential.** Any read of the headline league table that treats the two six-project firms as the competitive pressure on a multifamily practice is wrong on both counts.

WHERE NOT TO SPEND THE CALL

Four developers that will not hire an outside architect

This falls out of the same data and is the part we would want if the positions were reversed. These are developers whose design work is structurally unavailable — not because they said no, but because of how they are built.

| DEVELOPER                | PROJECTS                                 | WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS                                                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Creation Equity          | 6 — the most active developer in the set | LGE Design Build on <b>all six</b> : five as design-builder, one as contractor alongside GFF Design. No outside architect appears on any Creation Equity project            |
| Ryan Companies US        | 4                                        | Developer <i>and</i> general contractor on all four, and it brings its own architect — Butler Design Group on three, Deutsch on the fourth                                  |
| Statesman Group          | 1 (565,729 sf, six buildings)            | Developer and contractor both. <b>No architect named at all</b>                                                                                                             |
| StreetLights Residential | The Langley, 134 units                   | Fully vertically integrated: <b>StreetLights Creative Studio</b> is architect and interior designer, <b>SLR Construction</b> is the general contractor. Every seat in-house |

The Butler–Ryan pairing is worth isolating: it is the **only architect-to-contractor relationship that repeats more than once** anywhere in the 50. Three projects together. Everything else in Arizona is a one-off pairing, which is another way of saying the same thing as the first section — this market has very few locked relationships.

THE THING YOU ASKED FOR

Phoenix submitted projects, from the city’s own record

Phoenix publishes a live planning and permit service. It currently carries **68,292 permits and 13,022 plan reviews**, row-level, **current to the day this was run**. Filtered to site-plan and rezoning cases it returns **373 open cases**; filtered to those submitted since 1 January 2025, **280**; of which **41 are residential by project name**.

Among its eighty case types the one that matters most is **FINAL SITE PLAN – MAJOR**. That is the submittal whose drawing set carries the project directory sheet — every consultant, by discipline, with contact details. It is how a full design team gets confirmed from a city record rather than inferred from a press release.

| SUBMITTED   | CASE    | PROJECT                                    | ADDRESS               | STAGE                          |
|-------------|---------|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------|
| 12 May 2026 | 2602491 | <b>Momentum Apartments</b>                 | 734 E Vineyard Rd     | Preliminary site plan          |
| 6 May 2026  | 2602468 | <b>Senior Housing at 41st Ave</b>          | 2700 N 41st Ave       | Preliminary site plan          |
| 21 Apr 2026 | 2602361 | <b>17th St Apartments</b>                  | 1634 E Wood St        | Preliminary site plan          |
| 9 Apr 2026  | 2602015 | Sagewood Phase 4 — residential & clubhouse | 4400 E Palo Verde Dr  | Preliminary site plan          |
| 1 Apr 2026  | 2601847 | Virginia Townhome Project                  | 4840 E Virginia Ave   | Preliminary site plan          |
| 25 Feb 2026 | 2601066 | Maryland Townhomes                         | 742 E Maryland Ave    | <b>Final site plan</b>         |
| 6 Feb 2026  | 2600890 | Lion Foundation Housing                    | 1415 E Wood St        | Preliminary site plan          |
| 24 Dec 2025 | 2507260 | <b>Deer Valley Apartments</b>              | 3010 W Deer Valley Dr | <b>Final site plan — major</b> |
| 11 Dec 2025 | 2506990 | 34th & Thomas Apartment Homes              | 3425 E Thomas Rd      | Preliminary site plan          |
| 9 Dec 2025  | 2506904 | 4th St Residences                          | 4144 S 4th St         | <b>Final site plan — major</b> |
| 9 Dec 2025  | 2506899 | Sierra Verde Townhomes                     | 4800 S 16th St        | <b>Final site plan — major</b> |

Eleven of the forty-one, newest first. The full set travels with this document.

#### × TWO THINGS THIS LIST IS NOT

**It is a snapshot, not a trend.** Every row carries status OPEN, because closed cases leave the layer. Counting them by year would show 2024 smaller than 2025 and that would mean nothing — older cases have simply had longer to close. Anyone who hands you a submissions-per-year chart built from this feed has made that mistake.

**And it does not name your architect competitor.** The feed has a field called PROFESS\_NAME, populated on 90.6% of plan reviews, and the name promises exactly that. Read the values and it is the licensed *contractor* — the most frequent entries are “TO BE BID”, “OWNER”, fire-sprinkler firms and solar installers. It is genuinely useful for who *builds* in Phoenix. It is not an architect and we will not present it as one.

**Scottsdale is the instructive counter-example.** Its case service is the cleanest we tested anywhere — 82 cases with all eight fields populated on all 82 rows, applicant included. And the newest submittal in it is **25 February 2026**, because the city moved to a new portal in January and the map only covers what came before. The live successor has a search API that requires an authentication token. **A perfect feed can still be a closed one**, and the only way to know which you are holding is to query it and look at the dates.

#### ▲ ON THE TEST YOU SET US

You asked what happens to a 40-storey project filed that morning. **It is not in any public feed yet, and nobody’s is.** It surfaces when the city posts the case or the trade press picks it up — typically days. The defensible claim is that nothing published gets missed. It is not that nothing unpublished is known, and we would rather say so than have you find out by testing it.

#### THE OTHER FIVE

## What the layer holds in the rest of your markets

Same standard throughout: a firm appears against a project only where that firm’s own page, the developer’s own release, or the public record says so. Where the design team is incomplete the gap is shown rather than filled.

| MARKET & PROJECT                                                     | ARCHITECT                    | CONTRACTOR         | STRUCTURAL                |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>NEVADA · A's Ballpark, Las Vegas</b><br>33,000 seats, 2028        | BIG + HNTB                   | Mortenson–McCarthy | <b>Thornton Tomasetti</b> |
| <b>NEVADA · Bally's Integrated Resort</b><br>26 ac, former Tropicana | Marnell Howryla              | —                  | <b>Thornton Tomasetti</b> |
| <b>HAWAII · Kalae, Ward Village</b><br>330 homes                     | Solomon Cordwell Buenz       | Layton             | <i>not named</i>          |
| <b>HAWAII · Āliā, Kaka'ako</b><br>457 units, 39 storeys              | WRNS Studio                  | —                  | <i>not named</i>          |
| <b>HAWAII · Launiu, Ward Village</b><br>486 homes, 40 storeys        | Arquitectonica               | —                  | <i>not named</i>          |
| <b>HOUSTON · The Lily River Oaks</b><br>38 storeys, 331 units        | Solomon Cordwell Buenz       | ANDRES             | <b>DeSimone</b>           |
| <b>HOUSTON · The Langley</b><br>20 storeys, 134 units                | StreetLights Creative Studio | SLR                | <i>not named</i>          |
| <b>DALLAS · Lucille, Uptown</b><br>22 storeys, 265 units             | HKS                          | Rogers-O'Brien     | <b>BDD</b>                |
| <b>MIAMI · Waldorf Astoria</b><br>100 storeys, 360 residences        | Sieger Suarez + Carlos Ott   | —                  | CHM <sup>Δ</sup> reported |
| <b>MIAMI · Delano Residences</b><br>90 storeys                       | Carlos Ott · CUBE3 (AOR)     | —                  | <i>not named</i>          |
| <b>CHARLOTTE · Queensbridge Collective</b><br>755 units, \$725M      | Goettsch Partners            | Clark              | <i>not named</i>          |
| <b>RALEIGH · Tributary, North Hills</b><br>332 units                 | Hickok Cole                  | John Moriarty      | <i>not named</i>          |

*not named* means no public record names one. It does not mean the seat is open, and we would not tell you it did.

▲ ONE PATTERN WORTH YOUR ATTENTION

**Solomon Cordwell Buenz is in two of your six markets** — Kalae in Honolulu and The Lily River Oaks in Houston — on residential towers of 330 and 331 units respectively. Both confirmed from the developers’ own releases. Whatever else the six markets have in common, one firm is already moving between them the way you are.

WHAT THIS CAN REACH

### Three markets that looked closed are open, and current to today

Clark County, Dallas and Charlotte all publish nothing useful in their open-data feeds — each stopped in 2020, 2021 and 2022 respectively. They did not stop building. **They changed permitting systems, and all three moved to the same platform.** Their live records are public, and reachable without an account:

| JURISDICTION                    | OLD FEED STOPPED | LIVE RECORD, VERIFIED             |
|---------------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Clark County — the Strip</b> | Feb 2021         | <b>Current to the day queried</b> |
| <b>Dallas</b>                   | Mar 2020         | <b>Current to the day queried</b> |
| <b>Charlotte</b>                | May 2022         | Aug 2026                          |

**Worked example.** The Athletics ballpark on the former Tropicana site returns **79 county records**, March 2025 to August 2026 — precast packages, electrical, fire apparatus access, grading, phased building permits. That is the construction sequence of the largest project on the Strip, permit by permit, from the public record.

▲ THE EARLIEST SIGNAL A CITY HOLDS

Dallas has logged roughly **197 pre-development meetings in 2026** — the first formal contact a developer has with the city, *before* entitlement, before the design team is chosen, before any of it reaches the trade press. Eighty-nine are visible.

△ Being straight about it: those Dallas records carry a date, a number and a status, **but no project name and no address**. It is a measure of how busy the market is, not a list of leads. Clark County does name its projects and their status, so there the same query is genuinely actionable. **The value differs by city and we will always say which.**

WHERE THE WORK IS ACTUALLY MOVING

## Raleigh's large multifamily flow quintupled. Las Vegas's did not move.

Counting permits above \$10M — large enough that a scheme cannot inflate the number by filing each building separately — gives a read on how much serious multifamily work each market is actually releasing.

| YEAR               | LAS VEGAS (CITY) | RALEIGH |
|--------------------|------------------|---------|
| 2022               | 3                | 6       |
| 2023               | 7                | 6       |
| 2024               | 4                | 3       |
| 2025               | 4                | 15      |
| 2026 (to late Aug) | 5                | 7       |

**Las Vegas has not changed in five years** — three to seven large multifamily permits a year, every year, with 2026 running at or slightly above that. **Raleigh went from three in 2024 to fifteen in 2025**, and 2026 is tracking around eleven: off the peak, but still three to four times the 2022–24 baseline. If BD effort is being allocated across these two markets on the assumption they behave alike, they do not.

× THREE THINGS THAT WOULD MAKE THIS CHART LIE

**Permit counts and permit values disagree, so we use both.** On raw counts Raleigh 2026 looks like +151% over 2025. It is not: the permits are half the size they were — \$7.2M average against \$15.9M — because a scheme files per building. Total value rose about 15%. **Anyone quoting the count alone is quoting an artefact**, which is why the table above uses only permits large enough to be whole projects.

**2026 is a part year** and is never compared to a full one without saying so.

**Las Vegas batch-issues.** Every one of its 2026 multifamily permits was issued in a single week in June. A month-by-month version of this chart would show a spike that means nothing about the market.

▲ AND THE HONEST LIMIT ON THE NEVADA COLUMN

This is the **City of Las Vegas**. The Strip, Bally's, the Riviera site and the resort work are in **unincorporated Clark County**, a separate jurisdiction whose records do not carry a valuation field in the public search. **So the Nevada column understates Nevada**, and we would rather say that than quietly let the number stand for the state.

The comparison is deliberately *within* each city rather than between them. Cities classify differently, set different permit thresholds and cover different land areas — a raw count of Raleigh against Las Vegas would be a manufactured finding. Each column is that market measured against its own history, on that city's own classification: Las Vegas by its MultiFam work type, Raleigh by new-construction permits whose description states apartment or multifamily.

WHO ELSE IS DOING WHAT YOU ARE DOING

## The firms operating across more than one of your markets

Most architecture practices are one-market businesses. The interesting ones are those serving many markets from a few offices — the same shape of firm, competing for the

same work.

| FIRM                     | WHERE WE FOUND THEM                                                     | SHAPE                                                                                                                |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Solomon Cordwell Buenz   | Houston (The Lily River Oaks, 331 u) and Honolulu (Kalae, 330 u)        | Two of your six, on near-identical residential towers. Both confirmed from the developers' own releases              |
| Cline Design Associates  | Raleigh (2 projects). Offices Raleigh, Charlotte, Austin, Washington DC | Calls itself a national design firm; multifamily, student and senior housing                                         |
| Charlan Brock Architects | Raleigh (Livano North Hills, 280 u)                                     | Florida-based, national multifamily and student housing since 1980                                                   |
| KTGY                     | Arizona (1 project)                                                     | Seven offices — Chicago, Denver, Irvine, LA, Oakland, Tysons, Pune. National multifamily, <b>no Southeast office</b> |
| Gensler                  | Arizona (3), and named on a Clark County scheme                         | Global, not multifamily-specialist                                                                                   |
| JDAVIS                   | Raleigh (4) — the local leader                                          | Raleigh + Philadelphia, 89 staff. Acquired by ISG May 2025                                                           |

**The pattern is the point.** None of these firms has an office in most of the markets it works in. KTGY covers the Southeast from seven offices, none of them in the Southeast. Cline reaches Texas and Washington from the Carolinas. **Serving many markets from few offices is not unusual in this business — it is the model the strongest multifamily practices already run.**

WHY THESE NUMBERS

What we did to keep this honest

Every figure above is either a query against a named public endpoint run on 27 August 2026, or a statement read off the named party's own page. Three habits produced the difference, and each came from getting something wrong first.

**Counts reconcile against the source's own labels**

The parser that read the 50 projects is checked against the document's own label count — 50 blocks against 50 Address:, 49 architects against 49 Architect:. An earlier parser silently under-reported and would have produced a tidier, wrong table. **A number that cannot be reconciled to its source is not reported.**

**The primary source wins, every time**

We checked trade-press figures against the party who has to be right about them. It disagreed four times out of four, and the primary source won each one.

**"Could not read it" is not "it is not there"**

Two pages we needed returned 403 and one portal requires an auth token. Those are recorded as blocked, never as absent. A negative finding has to be earned.

▲ WHERE A DESIGN TEAM ACTUALLY COMES FROM

No permit feed anywhere names an architect — not one of the fourteen tested. Every field that looks like it might is the *contractor*. The design team comes from two places instead, and both are public:

**1. The drawing set.** Cities that publish plan sets carry the project directory on the cover sheet, and the design firm's copyright block on every sheet. That is how the Raleigh figures in this document were built.

**2. The contractor's own project page.** The contractor is the one field populated in every permit feed, and contractors publish their projects with the design team attached. Livano North Hills is the example: no trade-press coverage names its architect, and its builder's project page names **Charlan Brock Architects** outright.

△ It is not a complete method — roughly one contractor page in three carries the team. But it converts the field that is always present into the field that never is, and it costs nothing.

| FIGURE                  | TRADE PRESS               | THE PARTY WHO HAS TO BE RIGHT                                                     |
|-------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ālia, Honolulu          | 477 units                 | <b>457</b> — WRNS Studio's own page, with a bedroom-by-bedroom breakdown          |
| Waldorf Astoria, Miami  | 1,049 ft · 387 residences | <b>1,046 ft · 360 residences</b> — the project engineer's own page                |
| Queensbridge, Charlotte | 600,000 sf office         | <b>356,000 sf</b> , 755 residential units — the developer's own page              |
| Hylo Park, Las Vegas    | 700 units on 73 acres     | <b>393 single-family homes</b> plus a lifestyle centre — the architect's own page |

#### ▲ HOW THE RALEIGH ARCHITECTS WERE OBTAINED

They are not in the permit feed, and they are not on the city's site-review application form — that form records the owner and the applicant, and the applicant is normally the civil engineer. The architect is in the **drawing set**, which Raleigh publishes: on the cover sheet's project directory, and stamped on every sheet in the design firm's copyright block.

So the chain runs **development-plan record** → **case number** → **published plan set** → **the firm named on the drawings**. Of **92** multifamily plans submitted since January 2024, **71** were published as the application form only, with no drawings. **21** came with a full drawing set. Of those 21, **12 name a building architect** and the remaining nine are civil or landscape submittals that name none — so the recovery is near-complete *on the sets that can answer*, which is what makes the percentages above safe to state.

One of the twelve was then removed: the firm captured was **Bass, Nixon & Kennedy**, picked up from the application's *Applicant* field. They are consulting engineers, not architects. Eleven remain.

#### × WHAT WE COULD NOT GET, STATED PLAINLY

Clark Construction's Queensbridge project page returns 403 and Scottsdale's live portal needs an authentication token, so both are blocked rather than empty. The structural engineer on the Waldorf Astoria is reported as CHM by secondary sources and is **not confirmed on that firm's own site**, which is why it carries a mark above. One further claim — a national engineer said to be on Queensbridge — failed verification against that firm's own project list and has been left out entirely rather than hedged.

Two of the six markets are covered project-by-project rather than statistically. **Only Arizona has a complete enough set to support the percentages in the first three sections**, and those percentages are not claimed for anywhere else.

**KOR Structural** — prepared for MVE + Partners, 27 August 2026. Every row count, date and percentage is reproducible from the endpoints named in the text.

Sources: AZ Big Media, 50 commercial real estate projects to know in 2026 · City of Phoenix Planning/Permit map service · City of Scottsdale Active\_CDS\_Cases · Hawaii Community Development Authority E